"POLITIC IS A DIRTY GAME." DISCUSS, CLOSELY REFERRING TO THE POLITICAL SITUATION IN YOUR COUNTRY

APPROACH

- Read and understand the question.

-Introduce your essay by defining politics (Key term)

-Link the introduction to the body (points)

-This question is double sided and requires a candidate, on one side to show

-how politics is a dirty game

-and on another how it is not a dirty game and can do some good

-Each side needs a minimum of five points

Politics is dirty	**3*5= 15**
Not dirty	**3*5=15**
Introduction	**= 5**
Spelling	**= 5**
Grammar	**=10**
Total	**=50**

-State each point, Explain it and give a relevant Example.

State= 1 mark

Explain= 1 mark

Illustrate/give an example = 1 mark

-Each point/view must appear in its own paragraph.

-Use indented paragraphing. (Do not skip lines)

-Before moving the other side of the question, give a transitional paragraph to signal to the examiner.

ANSWER

Politics is a critical aspect of society that involves the management of public affairs and the formulation of policies that affect people's lives. It involves various actors, including political leaders, citizens, interest groups, and the media. While some view politics as a noble pursuit aimed at serving the common good, others see it as a dirty game characterized by deceit, corruption, and manipulation. In Uganda, politics has been marked by various controversies, scandals, and incidents that have reinforced the perception that politics is indeed a dirty game. Politics is viewed as a dirty game because of the following reasons.

Corruption is one of the most significant challenges facing the Ugandan political system. Politicians have been implicated in various corruption scandals, including the embezzlement of public funds and kickbacks making people look at it as a dirty game.. For instance, in 2012, the Ugandan government lost over $13 million in donor aid due to corruption in the Office of the Prime Minister.

The manipulation of election results through vote rigging is a common practice which makes ugandans consider politics a dirty game. Political parties and candidates use various tactics to rig elections, including voter intimidation, bribery, ballot stuffing, and falsification of results. For example, in the 2016 presidential elections, opposition candidate Kizza Besigye accused the ruling party of rigging the election.

Political violence is anotherserious problem that has marred the Ugandan political landscape making it a dirty game. Political actors often resort to violence to intimidate opponents and gain an advantage. For instance, in the run-up to the 2021 presidential elections, supporters of opposition candidate Bobi Wine were reportedly attacked by security forces.

Nepotism is a rampant problem in Ugandan politics, where political leaders often appoint family members and friends to positions of power, regardless of their qualifications. For example, President Yoweri Museveni appointed his son, Muhoozi Kainerugaba, as the commander of Uganda's special forces.

The Ugandan government has a history of **censoring the media**, particularly during election periods. Journalists who report critically on the government or opposition candidates risk being arrested or harassed. For example, in the run-up to the 2021 presidential elections, the government shut down social media platforms to prevent the spread of dissenting views.

Political patronage is a practice where political leaders reward loyal supporters with positions of power or access to resources. This practice has led to a culture of sycophancy and a lack of accountability. For example, in 2018, the President appointed his wife, as the Minister of Education and Sports, despite criticism from opposition politicians and civil society groups.

Lack of transparency in ugandan politics make it a dirty game.: Transparency is essential in ensuring accountability in the political system. However, in Uganda, there is a lack of transparency in how public resources are allocated and used. For example, the Auditor General's reports have revealed irregularities in the management of public funds, but little action has been taken to hold those responsible accountable.

Politicization of ethnicity is another trick used by politicians in uganda portrayed politics a dirty game Ethnicity is an important factor in Uganda's politics, with political leaders often using it to mobilize support from their ethnic groups. This practice has led to the marginalization of other ethnic groups and created tensions between them. For example, in the 2021 presidential elections, some candidates specifically targeted ethnic groups in their campaigns.

Ugandan politicians lack of political will yet addressing the challenges facing Uganda's political system requires political will. However, political leaders have been accused of lacking the will to implement reforms that would promote transparency, accountability, and good governance. For example, the passage of the Anti-Corruption Act in 2009 has not resulted in significant reductions in corruption.

Perpetuation of the status quo is another indicator of political dirtiness: Uganda's political system has been dominated by the ruling party, the National Resistance Movement (NRM), since 1986. The NRM's hold on power has made it difficult for opposition parties to gain traction, leading to accusations of a lack of democracy. For example, in the 2021 presidential elections, opposition candidate Bobi Wine claimed that the election was rigged in favor of the incumbent, President Museveni.

Despite the fact that many people view politics as a dirty game, characterized by corruption, deceit, and manipulation, it is not accurate to view politics as inherently dirty. Politics can be advantageous to citizens world over and uganda in particular as discussed below. (***Transitional paragraph)***

Politics can bring about positive change: One of the primary functions of politics is to bring about positive change in society. Through the political process, policies can be formulated and implemented to improve people's lives. For example, in Uganda, the government has implemented policies to improve access to healthcare, education, and infrastructure.

Politics can promote transparency and accountability: Politics can promote transparency and accountability by ensuring that those in power are held responsible for their actions. Through the political process, citizens can hold their elected representatives accountable for their actions and decisions. For example, in Uganda, civil society groups have been able to use the political process to hold government officials accountable for corruption and other forms of malfeasance.

Politics can promote diversity and inclusivity: Politics can promote diversity and inclusivity by ensuring that different voices are heard and represented. Through the political process, marginalized groups can have a say in the decisions that affect their lives. For example, in Uganda, women and minority groups have been able to use the political process to advocate for their rights and interests.

Politics can promote peaceful coexistence: Politics can promote peaceful coexistence by providing a platform for dialogue and conflict resolution. Through the political process, different groups can come together to find common ground and work towards a shared vision. For example, in Uganda, the political process has been used to resolve conflicts between different ethnic and religious groups.

Politics can foster civic engagement and participation. Politics can foster civic engagement and participation by encouraging citizens to get involved in the political process. Through voting, advocacy, and activism, citizens can have a say in the decisions that affect their lives. For example, in Uganda, the political process has been used to mobilize citizens to advocate for environmental protection, human rights, and other issues.

Politics can promote innovation and progress. Politics can promote innovation and progress by providing a platform for new ideas and approaches. Through the political process, policymakers can explore different options and strategies for addressing social and economic challenges. For example, in Uganda, the government has implemented policies to promote entrepreneurship and innovation, such as the Innovation Fund and the Presidential Initiative on Banana Industrial Development.

Last but not least, Politics can foster international cooperation and collaboration: Politics can foster international cooperation and collaboration by providing a platform for dialogue and diplomacy between nations. Through the political process, countries can work together to address global challenges, such as climate change, poverty, and conflict. For example, Uganda has been actively involved in regional and international organizations, such as the East African Community (EAC), the African Union (AU), and the United Nations (UN), to promote cooperation and collaboration on various issues.

In conclusion, while there may be instances of corruption, deceit, and manipulation in politics, it is not accurate to view politics as inherently dirty. Politics can bring about positive change, promote transparency and accountability, promote diversity and inclusivity, and promote peaceful coexistence. By engaging in the political process, citizens can work towards a better future for themselves and their communities. It is right to assert it is rather politicians who are dirty not politics.